for the assembly. If the TDP-JSP-BJP alliance does coalesce with any degree of coherence, it could spell serious trouble for Jagan.

The YSRCP supremo has other worries as well. Sharmila's strident campaign is already weaning away a section of old YSR loyalists—leaders, cadres and voters alike. With Naidu drifting to the NDA fold, Sharmila is in talks to rope in the CPI, CPI(M) and other fringe parties opposed to the NDA, to help the Congress boost its vote share. In effect, though, a triangle of fronts in the fray will split the anti-YSRCP vote and indirectly help Jagan.

Conscious of the challenges, Jagan has targeted both the TDP and the Congress. He calls Naidu "a fascist who has no guts to fight the polls without alliances and no face to seek votes with his past performance". As for the Congress, he says it pursues a "divide and rule" policy, whether committed on Telugu society like it did by splitting the state in 2014 or by dividing his family—first by fielding his late uncle Y.S. Vivekananda Reddy against his mother and now by pitting sister Sharmila against him. That could just about suffice. "A dent in the YSRCP vote bank and loss of some seats are inevitable as Jagan has neglected sections like government employees, pensioners and the educated youth. But re-election looks quite certain," says political analyst Dr Subramanyam Reddy. "The vast majority of beneficiaries of the DBT schemes will back him for another term."

The risk could come from elsewhere: disgruntled leaders quitting the YSRCP and fuelling the anti-incumbency campaign. The succees of Jagan's *siddham* battle cry will depend on how many on his side are ready to stay, or are ready to desert him. ■

